straight open fingers with just necessary movements of hand. Because excessive mixing may form the gluten and this toughness will spoil the cake quality.

After folding the flour, if the batter is very stiff, add some quantity of water or milk to adjust the batter consistency.

## 2. Flour batter method

In the flour batter method cream the fat and a quantity of flour not exceeding the weight of fat till it becomes light and fluffy. At the same time, in another machine, beat the egg and equal quantity of sugar till it comes stiff and frothy. Then add the egg and sugar mixture gradually in small quantity at a time into the first mixture. It should be mixed thoroughly and then only the next portion should be added. The remaining sugar is dissolved in milk or water and added to the mixture. Any colour or flavour is also added along with this liquid. Lastly, the remaining flour is sifted and mixed.

The following points should be borne in mind while preparing the cakes in the flour batter method:

In the above case, milk or water, part of sugar, part of flour equal to that of milk are mixed into a smooth paste and added. The remaining flour should be sifted with baking powder and added at the last stage of mixing.

As in this method, it is possible to control the curdling and gluten formation. This method is suitable for lean cakes because lean cakes acquire most of the aeration due to baking powder and there is no risk of losing aeration achieved in fat.

## 3. Blending Method

In the blending method, fat, flour, baking powder and salt are whipped

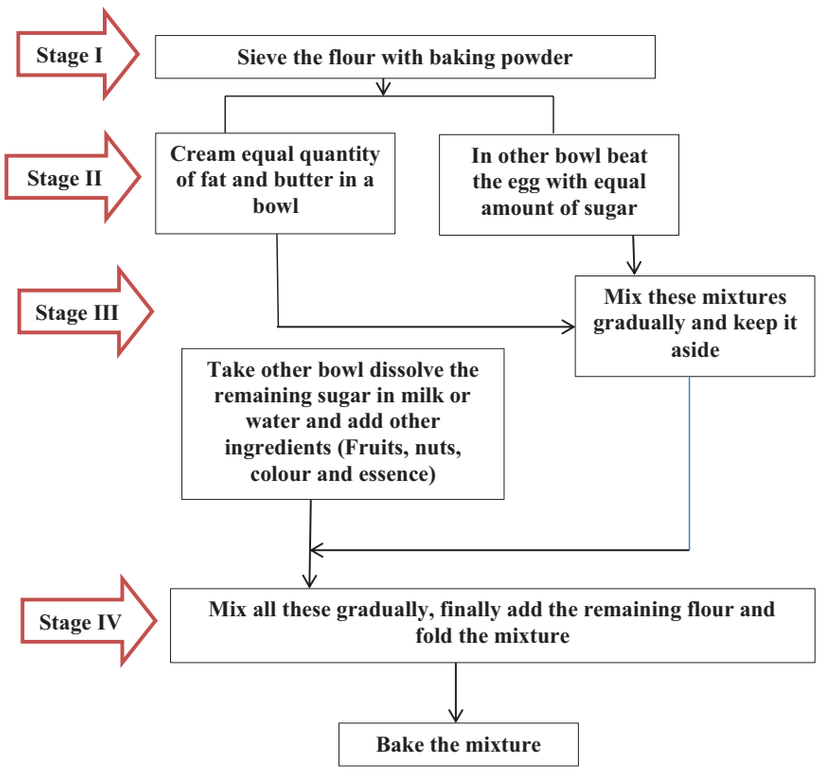



**Figure 4.2 Flour Batter Method**



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